

Word family: **lay / lays / laid / laying / layer**

Base word: lay

Forms: lays, laid, laying

Related form: layer

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Inside, the ceilings are high, the space feels open, and everything is **laid out** in a very orderly way.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **laid out** means **arranged or organized in a particular way**.

繁體中文： **被安排、佈置或排列成某種方式**

中文翻譯：

> “...everything is **laid out** in a very orderly way.”

「.....一切都被**佈置 / 安排得井然有序**。」

Here:

lay out = 把東西按照某種方式安排、擺放或設計

Because **lay out** is essential to the exact target sentence, it should be mapped explicitly even though phrasal verbs are normally excluded by default.

1. **lay = put something down in a particular position (放置) — 放下 ; 擺放**

Meaning: To put something somewhere, especially carefully or deliberately.

Practice 1

> “She **laid** the book on the table.”

「她把書**放在**桌上。」

Practice 2

> “He **laid** the keys beside the phone.”

「他把鑰匙**放在**電話旁邊。」

****lay = 把某物放到某個位置****

Common:

- * lay something on the table
- * lay something down
- * lay something beside something

This is the central physical sense.

2. ****lay = put/spread something over a surface (鋪設) — 鋪 ; 鋪設****

****Lay**** can mean placing material over a surface.

Practice 3

> “Workers ****laid**** new flooring.”

「工人****鋪設****了新的地板。」

Practice 4

> “They ****laid**** a carpet in the room.”

「他們在房間裡****鋪了****地毯。」

****lay = 把地板、地毯、電纜等鋪放在某個表面或位置****

Common:

- * lay flooring
- * lay carpet
- * lay cable
- * lay bricks

This is a major practical branch.

3. ****lay = arrange/set something in position (安排 / 佈置) — 安排 ; 擺放****

****Lay**** can mean to arrange things into a particular pattern or position.

Practice 5

> “She ****laid**** the documents in a neat row.”

「她把文件****整齊排放****成一行。」

Practice 6

> “The table was ****laid**** for dinner.”

「餐桌已經****擺設好****，準備用餐。」

****lay = 把物件按照某種用途或形式擺放好****

This is closely related to Meaning 1 but useful enough to show separately.

4. ****lay out = arrange or organize visually/spatially (片語) — 佈置；排列；規劃****

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Practice 7 — Original

> “Everything is ****laid out**** in a very orderly way.”

「一切都被****佈置得井然有序****。」

Practice 8

> “The garden is ****laid out**** in a formal style.”

「花園按照正式風格****規劃 / 佈置****。」

Practice 9

> “The information is clearly ****laid out**** on the page.”

「資料在頁面上****排列得很清楚****。」

****lay out = 把空間、資訊或物件有系統地安排、排列或設計****

5. **lay = produce eggs (動物) — 產卵 ; 下蛋**

Lay has a completely different biological sense.

Practice 10

> “Hens **lay** eggs.”

「母雞會**下蛋**。」

Practice 11

> “The turtle came ashore to **lay** its eggs.”

「那隻海龜上岸**產卵**。」

lay eggs = 產卵 / 下蛋

This is a major distinct core meaning.

6. **lay = establish/place something abstract (奠定) — 奠定 ; 設下**

Lay can mean establishing a foundation, basis, rule, or plan.

Practice 12

> “The research **laid** the foundation for later work.”

「這項研究為後來的工作**奠定了基礎**。」

Practice 13

> “The agreement **laid** the groundwork for cooperation.”

「這項協議為合作**奠定了基礎**。」

lay = 建立某種基礎、框架或前提

Common:

* lay the foundation

* lay the groundwork

* lay the basis

This is an important figurative branch.

7. **lay** = place responsibility/blame/emphasis (抽象) — 加於 ; 歸於 ; 著重

Lay appears in many fixed constructions.

Practice 14

> “They **laid** the blame on poor planning.”

「他們把責任**歸咎於**規劃不善。」

Practice 15

> “The report **lays** emphasis on safety.”

「報告**著重**安全。」

lay + abstract noun = 把責任、重點、要求等放到某人 / 某事上

For strict counting, this is best treated as a figurative extension of “put/place.”

8. **lay** = set/install something technical (技術) — 敷設 ; 鋪設

Practice 16

> “They are **laying** new pipes.”

「他們正在**敷設**新管道。」

Practice 17

> “The company **laid** fibre-optic cables.”

「公司**鋪設**了光纖電纜。」

This belongs under the broader physical-placement sense.

Related form: **layer**

****Layer**** means a thickness or level of material covering something or stacked with others.

Practice 18

> “A thin ****layer**** of dust covered the shelf.”

「架子上覆蓋着一層薄薄的灰塵。」

Practice 19

> “The cake has three ****layers****.”

「這個蛋糕有三****層****。」

****layer = 一層覆蓋物或上下堆疊的層次****

It is related historically and conceptually, but it functions as an independent noun.

Important distinction: ****lay vs lie****

This is the most important learner distinction.

****lay****

usually takes an object:

> “Lay the book on the table.”

= 把書放在桌上。

****lie****

does not take an object:

> “The book lies on the table.”

= 書在桌上。

So:

* ****lay something****

* ****lie somewhere****

Important distinction: **lay** vs **put**

put

is the broad everyday word for placing something somewhere.

lay

often suggests:

- * careful placement
- * horizontal placement
- * arrangement
- * formal/fixed collocations

> put the book down

> lay the book on the table

Both may work, but **lay** can sound more deliberate.

Important distinction: **lay** vs **place**

place

is slightly more formal and neutral.

lay

often implies putting something down or arranging it.

> place the vase on the shelf

> lay the papers on the desk

Important distinction: **lay** vs **arrange**

arrange

emphasizes organization/order.

lay

emphasizes placing physically.

> arrange the chairs

> lay the materials on the table

In **lay out**, the meanings overlap strongly.

Grammar note: **lay** is irregular

Present:

> lay / lays

Past:

> **laid**

Past participle:

> **laid**

-ing:

> **laying**

So:

> lay → laid → laid

This is often confused with **lie**:

> lie → lay → lain

That contrast is worth memorizing.

Useful construction: **lay out** — arrange / explain

Besides physical arrangement, **lay out** can also mean to explain something clearly.

Practice 20

> “She **laid out** the plan in detail.”

「她把計劃**清楚列出 / 說明**。」

This is another common phrasal extension.

Useful construction: **lay down — establish a rule**

Practice 21

> “The law **lays down** clear requirements.”

「法律**訂明**了清晰的要求。」

This is a phrasal construction and should remain outside the bare-word core unless specifically targeted.

Useful construction: **lay off — stop employing**

Practice 22

> “The company had to **lay off** several workers.”

「公司不得不**裁員**。」

Again, this is lexicalized and separate from the core sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **lay**

* **lays**

* **laid**

* **laying**

* **layer**

The strongest semantic branches are:

* put/place

* spread/install

- * arrange
- * produce eggs
- * establish a basis
- * abstract placement in fixed expressions

The exact target phrase **lay out** should be preserved because it is central to the sentence.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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lay — put/place	把某物放到某個位置，通常帶有較刻意或有安排的感覺
lay — spread/install	把地板、地毯、電纜、管道等鋪設 / 敷設好
lay — arrange	把物件按某種用途、次序或形式排列 / 擺放
lay out	有系統地佈置、排列、規劃；亦可指清楚說明
lay — eggs	產卵；下蛋
lay — foundation	奠定基礎、建立前提或框架
lay — abstract placement	把責任、重點、要求等放在某人 / 某事上
layer	一層物質 / 結構；相關詞彙

For your original sentence

> “...everything is **laid out** in a very orderly way.”

The exact meaning is:

laid out = 所有物件、空間和設施都按照清楚、有秩序的方式安排好

So:

> **laid out in a very orderly way**

= **佈置得非常井然有序**

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **lay**:

- put/place something somewhere**
- spread/install something over or along a surface**
- arrange/set things in position**
- produce eggs**
- establish a foundation/basis**

I would merge abstract “lay blame/emphasis” uses into #1/#5 depending on context, and keep **lay out** as an essential phrasal extension because it is the target construction here.